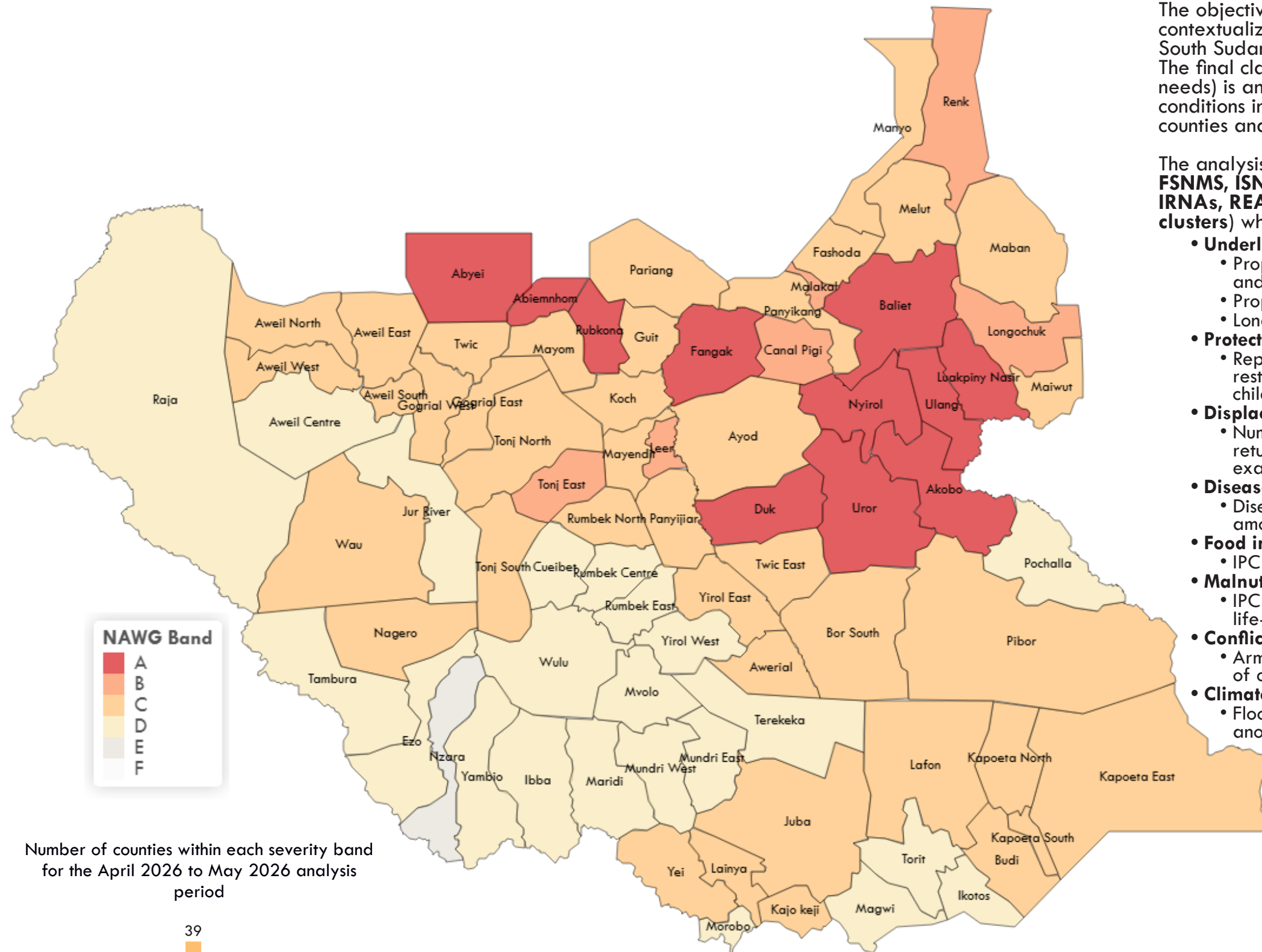


SOUTH SUDAN – NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

April 2026 – May 2026 Analysis



For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Kumudu Sanjeewa (sanjeewa@un.org) or Mary Langan (mary.langan@impact-initiatives.org).

Background

The NAWG meeting was held on June 9, 2026 to discuss the analysis of the **April 2026 to May 2026** period.

The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of critical life-saving humanitarian needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization by the ICCG. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The analysis encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, ACLED, INSO, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as a significant number of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used as a proxy for life-threatening acute malnutrition and excess mortality risk.
- **Conflict**
 - Armed conflict events, conflict-related sexual violence, forced recruitment of children, targeted killings of civilians, targeted property destruction
- **Climate shocks**
 - Flood-related displacement, flood extent, drought stress, rainfall anomalies.

Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B	7 - 7.9	Very severe humanitarian conditions
C	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions
D	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
E	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
F	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

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April 2026 – May 2026 Analysis

The April to May 2026 NAWG analysis shows a broadly stable but severe humanitarian picture across South Sudan after several cycles of deterioration. The mean Needs Severity Score edged down marginally from 6.28 to 6.26, the eleven Band A (Extreme humanitarian conditions) counties are unchanged, and 75 of 79 counties remained in the same band. Four counties changed band in the backend analysis: Leer moved up from Band C to Band B, while Pibor, Twic and Mundri East each moved down one band.

Displacement tracking recorded 126,435 individuals displaced over the period, and an estimated 389,000 people have been affected by conflict so far in 2026. The most significant movement this cycle was the return of tens of thousands of people from Ethiopia to Akobo and surrounding areas, with 78,873 returnees recorded across Jonglei and Upper Nile by 7 May, nearly 36,000 of them to Akobo; these returns remain fluid and are largely driven by deteriorating conditions in displacement sites rather than improved security at home.

The April to July 2026 IPC projection remains unchanged this cycle and continues to underpin the overall severity profile. Pockets of populations in Akobo, Fangak, Nyirol and Uror in Jonglei, and in Luakpiny/Nasir and Ulang in Upper Nile, are projected in IPC AFI Phase 5 (Catastrophe). A credible risk of Famine has been identified in Akobo and Nyirol, and in the most affected, inaccessible areas of Luakpiny/Nasir and Ulang under a worst-case scenario, with the period of greatest concern extending through September 2026. The national cholera outbreak totalled 104,648 cases and 1,678 deaths across 55 counties as of late May, with active transmission now concentrated in Unity State, which accounted for about 88 per cent of the most recent caseload.

Counties Facing “Extreme” Humanitarian Conditions

Eleven counties were classified as experiencing **extreme humanitarian needs (Band A)** during this analysis period. These counties are **Ulang, Luakpiny/Nasir, Rubkona, Fangak, Duk, Baliet, Uror, Nyirol, Akobo, Abiemnhom, and Abyei.**

Discussion and Joint Analysis

- **Leer:** The appointment of a parallel military authority created administrative friction near the high-value Adok Port logistics hub. Leer is among the Unity locations where cholera has resurged and is included in the approved oral cholera vaccination campaign. Localised clashes between government-aligned armed youth and opposition forces were reported in late May. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**

- **Longochuk:** Holds the highest needs severity score in Band B and remains affected by active conflict and access constraints. In mid-May, local authorities appealed for urgent assistance following renewed clashes that reportedly displaced more than 7,200 people to Udier payam and restricted access to farmland during the main agricultural season. Partners noted that severity will depend on whether humanitarian partners can deliver assistance in the coming weeks given current access constraints. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**
- **Tonj East:** Remains in Band B amid a sharp deterioration in Warrap driven by escalating intercommunal violence and cross-border cattle raids. It recorded the deadliest county-level toll among the discussion counties over April to May, with at least 72 fatalities across eight events, including around 40 people killed in a single 25 April clash at a cattle camp. Earlier violence displaced an estimated 24,600 individuals, and partners sustained emergency health and nutrition interventions. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**
- **Malakal:** Partners reported a rise in gender-based violence disproportionately affecting girls and young women, against a backdrop of weakened response capacity and a transitional gap in protection coordination. The environment around Malakal, the former Protection of Civilians site and Bulukat Transit Centre was generally calm by late May but assessed as fragile, with a mid-April intercommunal clash in Eastern Malakal triggered by a cattle dispute. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**
- **Renk:** Remains the principal entry and transit point for arrivals from Sudan along the Eastern Corridor, and displacement pressure is building as conflict intensifies across the border in Blue Nile State. An assessment found more than 15,000 refugees and returnees urgently requiring assistance, and service delivery is strained, with sharp fuel-price increases, severe water-access challenges and the town water treatment plant at risk. Member agencies reported a continued influx not captured in the backend analysis, with around 200 to 250 individuals arriving per day across crossing points, alongside measles cases, cholera risk, seasonal flooding concerns and housing, land and property issues. **Final classification: Elevated to Band B.**
- **Pibor:** An inter-agency convoy bound for Akobo was stranded in Pibor for part of the period owing to impassable roads before reaching its destination. A humanitarian vehicle was ambushed and robbed in early May, and field consultations highlighted entrenched harmful practices including child betrothal, abduction and sexual violence. The county recorded six conflict events and 28 fatalities over April to May. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**

- **Twic:** Sits within a Warrap context assessed as significantly deteriorating over the second half of May due to intercommunal violence and cross-border cattle raids in neighbouring counties. Repeated April clashes were recorded as armed youth from Unity State raided cattle from local communities. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Mayom:** The county is a focus of the Unity cholera response, reporting 190 cholera cases over the four weeks to 28 May, second only to Rubkona, and is included in the approved oral cholera vaccination campaign. Cross-state cattle raids remain a persistent driver of intercommunal violence, with several clan clashes recorded over the period. Members noted no displacement reported despite the cattle-raiding incidents. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Panyikang:** Flagged due to displacement, access constraints and persistent insecurity. Displacement tracking recorded 1,716 individuals displaced, driven by repeated April fighting over the strategic Tonga corridor. Members reported population movement from neighbouring counties, with some people hiding in swamps due to conflict. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to track the evolving situation and share any relevant information. **All 11 Band A counties remain under close monitoring by default, and Panyikang was added to the list during the meeting.**

Additional close monitoring is recommended for several Unity and Jonglei counties due to early flood impacts, disease risks, displacement, and exposure to seasonal flooding. In Unity, Mayendit, Panyijiar and Guit remain of concern due to early flood impacts in Mayendit and Panyijiar, cholera risks in Panyijiar, and displacement and protection concerns in Guit. Ayod is also flagged following the highest recorded flood extent nationally in May and continued cholera cases, although members noted that the county remains comparatively stable relative to neighbouring counties, with low displacement and several responses underway.

Further monitoring is also recommended for counties affected by conflict, protection risks, disease outbreaks, or cross-border shocks. Mundri East and Mundri West remain flagged due to intercommunal violence, displacement and insecurity in Western Equatoria. Awerial is flagged due to high cholera case fatality rates, while Magwi is flagged for cross-border health and access risks, including cholera resurgence, Ebola preparedness concerns and border-related commodity disruptions. Gogrial East also remains on close monitoring due to the deteriorating protection environment in Warrap.